companies to operate in India without a local collaborator. While the group exited from these businesses, it entered five new ones too.

Kishor Chaukar was tasked with the responsibility of overseeing the projects promoted by TIL in the new business areas. Manab Bose, was assigned the primary responsibility of addressing human resource issues which was given ‘central focus’ by Ratan. He said that there was a ‘need to have this as one of the foundation stones of a unified group with a unified direction’.

Ratan also formed the Corporate Assurance Group (CAG) to promote brand equity management, the TCoC, and to steer the JRD QV Award. Its remit was wide. It was also tasked with assisting in the improvement of processes and systems to help companies enhance their performance and reach leadership positions. As an integral part of this role, it had to monitor the progress of companies complying with the JRD QV programme. Besides, it was made responsible for both internal and external communication strategy and enhancing the Tata brand.

In November 1998, the GEO also established the Group Strategy Forum (GSF), which acted as a discussion board for the plans and programmes that it wished to implement. Headed by Ratan, the forum included the GEO members along with senior leaders from the Tata Group.

Within a decade, Ratan as chairman had transformed the group from a loose confederation into a structure with a more unified architecture, with the companies having the autonomy to pursue their policies so long as they were aligned with the goals prescribed at the group level. In 2002, Ratan heaped praise on the GEO, stating that it had put ‘certain important hooks’ in place which included a ‘central HR, and central financial coordination with a view to standardize the MIS systems of our companies for financial reporting’.

The Business Review Committees

Among the several initiatives that Ratan had taken to restructure the group was the creation of the Business Review Committees (BRCs). These were established in 1998 by the Tata Strategic Management Group (TSMG), which functioned as a division of TIL and was focused on scanning business opportunities for it and for group companies. Each BRC included the chairman or vice chairman of the company along with its MD/CEO and